gets invoked from the appropriate security hook point and checks if the contact to whom the SMS is to be sent is part of the contact whitelist. An outgoing SMS could get blocked if the contact is not part of the whitelist, and an appropriate enterprise policy compliance alert is generated to warn the user.

Device management APIs

This component resides at the framework layer. It provides APIs for device management applications. It is basically a wrapper layer over the policy enforcement component and is capable of reading or updating policy configuration information.

This component defines a custom permission. Any application that uses these APIs is required to use the pre-defined permission. It also enables some pre-determined listeners (that would be implemented at the device admin app end) to receive notifications on updates in the device policy configuration.

Device admin application

The device admin application (also called an on-device agent) resides at the application layer. It allows the retrieval and updating of various device management policies and their details. It accomplishes this by leveraging the device management APIs for reading and updating policy. The device admin application requires pre-defined permission for using device management APIs.

Deploying this platform on a device alone would not make it manageable. The mobile device management (MDM) vendor or OEM needs to implement the corresponding device admin application in order to support this platform for the MDM solution to be used.

To conclude, with the increasing growth in enterprise mobility, smartphones powered with an enterprise-ready Android platform have become the need of the hour. In order to address this need, enterprise mobility solution providers offer ready to use, enterprise ready Android platforms with pluggable points for customisation. The platform can be easily tailored and customised as per specific needs, and then factory set on Android devices to gain the required manageability of devices. END

By: Pooja Maheshwari

The author is a technical architect at Impetus Technologies. She has been working in the software domain for more than 12 years, with wide exposure in analysis, design and development of enterprise mobility solutions, mobile device management solutions and Android-based custom device solutions for enterprises. She is currently involved in accessing challenges and opportunities in applicability of Embedded Android for enterprises in various verticals. She can be reached at *pooja.a.maheshwari@gmail.com*